The work of the NSA was in several ways to be above the political fray. Party politics was seriously frowned upon. The military also took it upon itself to reform organized labor in Burma, making unions more grassroots and less top down. This infusion of new leadership would also lead to more confidence in the political system.

The most successful policy of the caretaker government was the “sweat” campaign. Started in late 1958, the campaign's goal was to instill civic pride and public responsibility in the citizens of Burma. Tun Sein led this massive clean-up effort, which would take place every Sunday. Members of the government, armed forces, and the public were involved in what became known as “Operation Clean-Up.” The Burmese government received assistance from the U.S. International Cooperation Administration in order to help with sewage and water supply problems. Infrastructural problems such as street repair and widening were addressed. Citizens were discouraged from chewing betel, which is spit out, leaving a messy residue on the walkways and streets.

The caretaker administration also encouraged the Burmese citizens to adopt good manners and teachers were to tighten discipline in the schools. A national registration system was also implemented in order to facilitate more law and order in society. Hundreds of rebels were killed or captured; many surrendered during this period. Ethnic minority and tribal leaders were either bought off or forced to surrender. Many administrative positions were now in the hands of the military rather than civilians. Crime did indeed drop during the 1959–1960 period.

Economic decision making by the military was increased during the caretaker period. General Aung Gyi took more direct control over economic policy. The Defense Service Institute increased its control over factories, shipping, and banking. Essentially the military was perceived as making sound judgments concerning economic policy. The fact that the military government seemed above the political fray (e.g., the military never formed a political party) helped it retain its legitimacy.

THE FINAL PHASE OF DEMOCRACY IN BURMA: 1960–1962